

be more uneconomical, but will also require more space and the use of more resources. Naturally, the demand for virtualisation professionals is high and there is a shortage of dexterous IT professionals in this domain. This is definitely a perfect time for interested candidates to cash in on this opportunity," says Oberoi.

The scope of a career in this terrain is immense. Interested candidates can choose between storage, network, desktop and application virtualisation. Explains Ravinder Kumar, technical manager for virtualisation, Koenig Solutions, New Delhi. "The areas where one can make a career in virtualisation are in software development, systems administration, quality engineering, systems support, marketing and more. Systems or virtualisation administrators manage applications, and monitor how these applications work together in a virtualised environment; quality engineers test desktop virtualisation software, and kernel developers play a key role in advancing the technology. With actualisation becoming mainstream, the conventional IT roles too have undergone a sea change, with recruiters looking for candidates proficient in virtualisation."

While enterprises are increasingly leaning towards virtualisation to leverage their IT resources, it is important to understand the skillsets one needs to have to match the demand. Tuhin Sinha, owner and CTO of the Academy of Engineering and Management, Kolkata (AEM), shares, "The skillsets vary and depend on what domain of virtualisation one wants to get into – development, support, services or marketing. The basic requirement is to have knowledge of the systems for software development careers in this spectrum. A basic knowledge of the Linux kernel,

accompanied with skills in C and C++, will boost employability. In a nutshell, virtualisation professionals will do well if they are highly proficient in operating systems, storage, networking, security, etc."

And do certifications in this domain shore up one's career prospects? "Certifications, though not mandatory, definitely boost one's employability in the virtualisation domain and give candidates that extra edge over their non-certified counterparts during the hiring process. But only certification from a reputed firm or authority will make a difference. After all, what matters is the sound technical skill base of a professional," adds Sinha.

Industry stalwarts claim that as virtualisation is a revolutionary model, it has made steady inroads into the open source ecosystem, too, thus opening a slew of opportunities for IT professionals. Alok Srivastava, chief executive officer and founder of Network NUTS, New Delhi, opines, "Earlier, companies did not have much choice and they resorted to proprietary virtualisation solutions. Now, with an upbeat open source virtualisation ecosystem, large businesses are heavily relying on open source for economic advantages. A few enterprises in Hyderabad are planning to migrate their servers to Red Hat. The bigger the size of the companies, the more number of servers will be based on open source. Naturally, the demand for open source professionals becomes high. In our institute, we do receive requests from various companies to provide training to their employees on Red Hat Linux Certification."

So, if you wish to give a fillip to your employability chances, a career in virtualisation is just for you! **END** 

By Priyanka Sarkar

The author is a member of the editorial team. She loves to weave in and out the little nuances of life and scribble her thoughts and experiences in her personal blog.

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